

Defect Report

AU Roadmap Project

Project Name: Adelaide University Program Roadmap

Course: Industry Research Project

Semester: Semester 1, 2026

Group Code: C261W-4037

Reported By:

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Version: 1.0

Document Status: Final

Last Updated: 11 May 2026

Total Defects: 45

Defect Status: 45 Fixed, 0 Open

Summary Table

ID	Title	Severity	Priority	Status	Fixed Date
DEF-001	Search Bar Redirects Unauthenticated Users to Login Page	High	High	Fixed	—
DEF-002	Insufficient Title Text Contrast on Dark Background	Medium	Medium	Fixed	—
DEF-003	.env Database Configuration Mismatch or Not Loaded	High	High	Fixed	—
DEF-004	Database Import Fails with ERROR 1050 and ERROR 1062	High	High	Fixed	—
DEF-005	Login Failure — Plaintext Passwords in seed.sql (401 Unauthorized)	Critical	Critical	Fixed	—
DEF-006	Vue Router 4 Deprecation Warning — next() Callback in Navigation Guards	Low	Low	Fixed	—
DEF-007	Roadmap Popup Menu Displays Course ID Instead of Course Name	Medium	High	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-008	Search Bar Course Result Navigates to a Blank Page	High	High	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-009	Homepage Alumni Data Out of Sync with Alumni Profile Page	Medium	Medium	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-010	Homepage Alumni Section Reverts to Static Data After Merge	High	High	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-011	Database Migration Script Fails — ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS Unsupported in MySQL	High	High	Fixed	01 Apr 2026
DEF-012	Community Conversation List API Fails Due to MySQL only_full_group_by Mode	High	High	Fixed	01 Apr 2026
DEF-013	Multiple Routes Break After auth.js Refactored to Named Exports	Critical	Critical	Fixed	01 Apr 2026
DEF-014	Alumni User IDs Inconsistent Between Live Database and seed.sql	Medium	Medium	Fixed	01 Apr 2026
DEF-015	Program Banner Images Not Displaying on Homepage and Preview Page	High	High	Fixed	01 Apr 2026
DEF-016	New Course Defaults to CS Program — No Matching Database Record	Medium	Medium	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-017	MIT Roadmap Year 1 Displays Placeholder Courses Not Offered by Adelaide	High	High	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-018	MIT Roadmap Year 2 Semester 1 Shows Unselected Cybersecurity Course	Medium	Medium	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-019	Community Hub getConversations API Error — MySQL only_full_group_by (Recurrence of DEF-012)	High	High	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-020	Route Files Break After auth.js Export Refactor — Recurrence of DEF-013	Critical	Critical	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-021	ALTER TABLE Migration Script Fails on	High	High	Fixed	14 Apr 2026

ID	Title	Severity	Priority	Status	Fixed Date
	MySQL — Recurrence of DEF-011				
DEF-022	Alumni User ID Mismatch on Live Database — Recurrence of DEF-014	Medium	Medium	Fixed	14 Apr 2026
DEF-023	Vue Router 4 Deprecation Warning — next() in Navigation Guards (Recurrence of DEF-006)	Low	Low	Fixed	28 Apr 2026
DEF-024	ProgramPreviewPage Crashes with TypeError on Missing career_outcomes Data	High	High	Fixed	28 Apr 2026
DEF-025	Dashboard and Resources Pages Display Blank When No Program Assigned	Medium	Medium	Fixed	28 Apr 2026
DEF-026	seed.sql Duplicate MIT career_outcomes INSERT Causes ERROR 1062	Medium	Medium	Fixed	28 Apr 2026
DEF-027	Avatar Shows Broken Image Briefly After Successful Upload	Low	Low	Fixed	28 Apr 2026
DEF-028	Student Portal Incorrectly Renders Public Navigation Bar	Medium	High	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-029	Sidebar Navigation Icons Not Horizontally Centred in Collapsed State	Low	Low	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-030	Timetable 'Today' Highlight Incorrect Under Adelaide Timezone	Medium	Medium	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-031	My Profile Page Incorrectly Exposes Editable Name and Email Fields	Medium	Medium	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-032	MIT Roadmap Displays Non-IT Courses (Accounting, Agriculture, Aviation, etc.)	High	Critical	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-033	Homepage Featured Programs Images Not Displaying	Medium	High	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-034	Auth Register / Login Validation Rules Not Taking Effect	High	High	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-035	Discussion Post / Reply Validation Rules Not Taking Effect	High	High	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-036	Community Send Message Missing receiver_id Validation	Medium	High	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-037	Community Connection Request — Type Mismatch Bypasses Self-Connect Check	Medium	Medium	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-038	Community Connection Response — Invalid Action Silently Treated as Reject	Medium	Medium	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-039	Auth Store Forces Logout on Any fetchUser Error	Medium	High	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-040	Student Sidebar Dashboard Link Highlighted on All Sub-Pages	Low	Low	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-041	Admin Dashboard Resources Card Navigates to Wrong Page	Low	Medium	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-042	My Profile Avatar Upload Button State Out of Sync with File Selection	Low	Low	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-043	Pagination Returns Infinity for totalPages	Medium	Medium	Fixed	07 May 2026

ID	Title	Severity	Priority	Status	Fixed Date
	When limit Is Zero				
DEF-044	Avatar Upload — Old File Cleanup Uses Empty catch, Swallowing Errors	Low	Low	Fixed	07 May 2026
DEF-045	Community Post Image Shows Broken Icon After Posting Without Page Refresh	Low	Low		07 May 2026

Defect Details

Initial Defects (Pre-Sprint)

DEF-001 Search Bar Redirects Unauthenticated Users to Login Page

Component	Frontend / Router	Sprint	Initial	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: —
Description	Search results navigation via navigateToResult redirected users to /student/alumni and /student/industry, both protected by requiresAuth: true. Unauthenticated users were involuntarily redirected to the login page.			
Resolution	Changed redirect targets to public routes /research/connect and /research/connect#partner, which do not require authentication.			

DEF-002 Insufficient Title Text Contrast on Dark Background

Component	Frontend / UI	Sprint	Initial	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: —
Description	Default text colour was used on dark backgrounds, producing insufficient contrast and reducing readability. The issue was likely to fail WCAG AA accessibility criteria.			
Resolution	Updated title colour to a high-contrast value (white or equivalent) to meet WCAG readability standards.			

DEF-003 .env Database Configuration Mismatch or Not Loaded

Component	Backend / Config	Sprint	Initial	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: —
Description	Environment variables DB_HOST, DB_USER, DB_PASSWORD, and DB_NAME in .env did not match the local MySQL instance, or the .env file was not loaded because require('dotenv').config() was absent from server.js.			
Resolution	Verified and corrected .env values against the local database. Confirmed require('dotenv').config() is present at the top of server.js.			

DEF-004 Database Import Fails with ERROR 1050 and ERROR 1062

Component	Database	Sprint	Initial	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: —
Description	Re-running schema.sql caused ERROR 1050 (Table 'users' already exists). Re-running seed.sql caused ERROR 1062 (Duplicate entry) due to repeated primary and unique key insertions.			
Resolution	Changed schema.sql to use CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS. Modified seed.sql to TRUNCATE relevant tables before insertion, or use INSERT IGNORE.			

DEF-005 Login Failure — Plaintext Passwords in seed.sql (401 Unauthorized)

Component	Backend / Auth	Sprint	Initial	FIXED
Severity	Critical	Priority	Critical	Fixed: —
Description	seed.sql stored passwords as plaintext strings. The auth controller uses bcrypt.compare() for validation, which cannot match plaintext values, causing all seeded user logins to fail with 401.			
Resolution	Replaced all plaintext passwords in seed.sql with the corresponding bcrypt hash values (e.g., password '11111111' mapped to its \$2b\$10\$... hash).			

DEF-006 Vue Router 4 Deprecation Warning — next() Callback in Navigation Guards

Component	Frontend / Router	Sprint	Initial	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: —
Description	router/index.js beforeEach guard used the Vue Router 3 style next() callback pattern, which is deprecated in Vue Router 4 and generates console warnings.			
Resolution	Replaced next({ name: 'Login' }) and similar calls with return { name: 'Login' }. Removed the next parameter from guard functions.			

Sprint: 18 Mar 2026 → 14 Apr 2026

DEF-007 Roadmap Popup Menu Displays Course ID Instead of Course Name

Component	Frontend / RoadmapTimeline	Sprint	0318 → 0414	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	High	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	RoadmapTimeline.vue rendered prereq.course_id and dependency IDs (depld) as raw numbers in the Prerequisites and Required For lists. No ID-to-name mapping was applied.			
Resolution	Added a courseMap computed property that flattens all courses from the roadmap prop into an { id: course } lookup table. Display now renders courseMap[id].code + courseMap[id].name, falling back to 'Course {id}' if the entry is missing.			

DEF-008 Search Bar Course Result Navigates to a Blank Page

Component	Frontend / SearchBar, Backend / searchController	Sprint	0318 → 0414	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	navigateToResult routed course results to /explore/programs/\${item.id} using the course ID, not the program ID, resulting in a non-existent program page. searchController.js also did not return a program_id field for course results.			
Resolution	Updated searchController.js courses query to LEFT JOIN program_courses and return MIN(pc.program_id) AS program_id. SearchBar.vue now uses item.program_id for navigation, falling back to /explore when program_id is absent.			

DEF-009 Homepage Alumni Data Out of Sync with Alumni Profile Page

Component	Frontend / Backend	Sprint	0318 → 0414	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	The homepage and the dedicated alumni page each called different API endpoints or queried different tables, causing data inconsistency between the two views.			
Resolution	Unified both pages to call the same API endpoint, ensuring data is sourced from a single authoritative location.			

DEF-010 Homepage Alumni Section Reverts to Static Data After Merge

Component	Backend / programController	Sprint	0318 → 0414	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	After a branch merge, getFeaturedAlumni and related functions in programController.js continued querying the legacy alumni table. The new data model had replaced this table with a users + alumni_profiles join structure.			
Resolution	Updated the three affected functions to JOIN users and alumni_profiles. Added u.avatar_url AS photo_url field alias to maintain frontend compatibility.			

DEF-011 Database Migration Script Fails — ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS Unsupported in MySQL

Component	Database / Migration	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (01 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 01 Apr 2026
Description	ALTER TABLE ... ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS is a PostgreSQL-specific syntax. MySQL does not support it, causing migration scripts to fail on execution.			
Resolution	Replaced the unsupported syntax with a conditional check against information_schema.columns to determine whether the column exists before executing ALTER TABLE.			

DEF-012 Community Conversation List API Fails Due to MySQL only_full_group_by Mode

Component	Backend / Community API	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (01 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 01 Apr 2026
Description	MySQL's default only_full_group_by mode rejected the GROUP BY query because m.content and m.created_at appeared in the SELECT clause without being included in GROUP BY or an aggregate function.			
Resolution	Refactored the SQL to use a subquery that first retrieves MAX(id) per conversation, then JOINS back to the messages table to retrieve the full row data.			

DEF-013 Multiple Routes Break After auth.js Refactored to Named Exports

Component	Backend / Middleware / Routes	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (01 Apr)	FIXED
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Severity	Critical	Priority	Critical	Fixed: 01 Apr 2026
Description	auth.js was changed from module.exports = authenticate (direct function export) to module.exports = { authenticate, optionalAuth } (object export). Existing imports using const authenticate = require('./middleware/auth') became undefined, breaking routes/auth.js, routes/discussions.js, and routes/admin.js.			
Resolution	Updated all three import sites to use destructured form: const { authenticate } = require('./middleware/auth').			

DEF-014 Alumni User IDs Inconsistent Between Live Database and seed.sql

Component	Database	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (01 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 01 Apr 2026
Description	seed.sql assumed alumni user IDs would be 4–12, but the live database already contained records that caused auto_increment to skip values. The actual inserted IDs were 10–18.			
Resolution	Manually inserted alumni_profiles records with correct IDs (10–18) in the live database. seed.sql retained IDs 4–12 for use on fresh database initialisation.			

DEF-015 Program Banner Images Not Displaying on Homepage and Preview Page

Component	Frontend / Backend / Database	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (01 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 01 Apr 2026
Description	HomePage.vue and ProgramPreviewPage.vue referenced program.image, but the database column is named banner_url. Additionally, all banner_url values were NULL.			
Resolution	Populated banner_url for five programs in the database with correct local image paths. Updated both frontend components to reference program.banner_url / p.banner_url. Added banner_url to the programs INSERT block in seed.sql.			

DEF-016 New Course Defaults to CS Program — No Matching Database Record

Component	Frontend / ManageCourses.vue, Backend / adminController.js	Sprint	0318 → 0414	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	When a new course was added via the admin interface, the UI implied a default CS program association, but no corresponding record was written to program_courses in the database. This caused a mismatch between what the admin saw and what was actually stored.			
Resolution	Two-part fix: (1) Added optional program mapping fields to the ManageCourses.vue create-course form — Program, Year Level, Semester, and Core/Elective. These fields are optional; the admin may create a course without binding it to any program. (2) Updated createCourse() in adminController.js (line 142) to first INSERT into courses, then conditionally INSERT into program_courses if program-related fields were supplied by the frontend. This ensures that if a program is explicitly selected, the database record is written atomically in the same request, eliminating the UI/database mismatch.			

DEF-017 MIT Roadmap Year 1 Displays Placeholder Courses Not Offered by Adelaide

Component	Database / Seed Data	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (14 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	seed.sql mapped MIT Year 1 to fictitious course codes (e.g., COMP5101) that do not correspond to real University of Adelaide courses, causing incorrect data to appear on the roadmap.			
Resolution	Replaced placeholder entries with actual courses: COMP SCI 7207, 7210, 7211, 7064, 7081, 7201, 7212, 7307, and PROJMGNT 5021. Updated program_courses mapping in the database accordingly.			

DEF-018 MIT Roadmap Year 2 Semester 1 Shows Unselected Cybersecurity Course

Component	Database / Seed Data	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (14 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	COMP5201 Cybersecurity Fundamentals was incorrectly mapped to MIT Year 2 Semester 1 in seed.sql. The student had not selected this course.			
Resolution	Removed the erroneous mapping from both program_courses in the database and seed.sql.			

DEF-019 Community Hub getConversations API Error — MySQL only_full_group_by (Recurrence of DEF-012)

Component	Backend / Community API	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (14 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	The only_full_group_by GROUP BY issue recurred in the Community Hub getConversations API endpoint. SELECT fields m.content and m.created_at were not included in GROUP BY or aggregated, causing MySQL strict mode to reject the query.			
Resolution	Applied the same resolution as DEF-012: refactored the SQL using a subquery to retrieve MAX(id) per conversation group, then JOINed back to the messages table for the complete row.			

DEF-020 Route Files Break After auth.js Export Refactor — Recurrence of DEF-013

Component	Backend / Middleware / Routes	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (14 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	Critical	Priority	Critical	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	The auth.js named-export breakage recurred after additional route files were added or the fix was not applied consistently. routes/auth.js, routes/discussions.js, and routes/admin.js all failed due to the same import incompatibility.			
Resolution	Applied the same resolution as DEF-013: updated all affected import sites to const { authenticate } = require('../middleware/auth').			

DEF-021 ALTER TABLE Migration Script Fails on MySQL — Recurrence of DEF-011

Component	Database / Migration	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (14 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	The ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS syntax error recurred in a subsequent migration script. MySQL again rejected the PostgreSQL-only syntax.			
Resolution	Applied the same resolution as DEF-011: replaced the unsupported syntax with an information_schema.columns existence check before running ALTER TABLE.			

DEF-022 Alumni User ID Mismatch on Live Database — Recurrence of DEF-014

Component	Database	Sprint	0318 → 0414 (14 Apr)	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 14 Apr 2026
Description	The alumni user ID inconsistency between the live database and seed.sql recurred when additional alumni data was seeded. The live database auto_increment gaps meant inserted IDs (10–18) did not match seed.sql expectations (4–12).			
Resolution	Applied the same resolution as DEF-014: manually inserted alumni_profiles with correct IDs in the live database; seed.sql values retained for fresh-install scenarios.			

Sprint: 28 Apr 2026

DEF-023 Vue Router 4 Deprecation Warning — next() in Navigation Guards (Recurrence of DEF-006)

Component	Frontend / Router	Sprint	0428	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: 28 Apr 2026
Description	Residual Vue Router 3 style next() callback usage persisted in router/index.js beforeEach after the initial fix, continuing to generate deprecation warnings.			
Resolution	Systematically replaced all next({...}) calls with return {...}, changed standalone next() to implicit returns, and removed the next parameter from all guard functions.			

DEF-024 ProgramPreviewPage Crashes with TypeError on Missing career_outcomes Data

Component	Frontend / ProgramPreviewPage	Sprint	0428	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 28 Apr 2026
Description	Programs 2–5 had no career_outcomes records. latestOutcome resolved to undefined, and a v-if directive directly accessed latestOutcome.employment_rate, causing a runtime TypeError crash.			
Resolution	Added a null guard to the v-if condition: latestOutcome && latestOutcome.employment_rate, preventing the crash when career outcomes data is absent.			

DEF-025 Dashboard and Resources Pages Display Blank When No Program Assigned

Component	Frontend / Dashboard, Resources	Sprint	0428	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 28 Apr 2026
Description	When authStore.user.program_id is null, the Dashboard and Resources pages rendered as completely blank with no feedback or explanation for the user.			
Resolution	Added a 'No program assigned' informational message on both pages, directing users to contact an administrator for assistance.			

DEF-026 seed.sql Duplicate MIT career_outcomes INSERT Causes ERROR 1062

Component	Database / Seed Data	Sprint	0428	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 28 Apr 2026
Description	seed.sql contained two separate INSERT blocks for career_outcomes, both including a record with (program_id=3, year=2023) for MIT. Running the seed caused a duplicate entry error on the unique key.			
Resolution	Removed the older MIT-specific INSERT block (lines 256–260 of seed.sql). Retained the unified INSERT block covering all programs.			

DEF-027 Avatar Shows Broken Image Briefly After Successful Upload

Component	Frontend / Profile	Sprint	0428	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: 28 Apr 2026
Description	After uploading an avatar, uploadAvatarHandler saved the file to frontend/public/avatar/. The frontend then replaced the blob URL preview with the server path /avatar/user_x_xxx.jpg. However, Vite's dev server had not yet registered the new file, causing a momentary broken image icon. The image appeared correctly after a page refresh.			
Resolution	Removed the line avatarPreview.value = res.data.data.avatar_url. The blob URL created by onFileChange is retained as the live preview. Only authStore.user.avatar_url is updated with the server path for future use.			

Sprint: 07 May 2026

DEF-028 Student Portal Incorrectly Renders Public Navigation Bar

Component	Frontend / AppHeader	Sprint	0507	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	High	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	AppHeader.vue rendered the white main navigation bar (main-nav-bar) globally, including within the /student/* portal. This created a redundant and visually incorrect double navigation for authenticated student users.			
Resolution	Added route-based logic to AppHeader.vue to suppress main-nav-bar rendering under /student/* paths. The portal-specific top information bar is preserved.			

DEF-029 Sidebar Navigation Icons Not Horizontally Centred in Collapsed State

Component	Frontend / Sidebar	Sprint	0507	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	When the sidebar was collapsed, sidebar-link retained the expanded state's padding and alignment, causing navigation icons to appear shifted to the right rather than centred.			
Resolution	Defined separate CSS rules for the collapsed state targeting sidebar-nav, sidebar-link, and icon elements to enforce horizontal centring.			

DEF-030 Timetable 'Today' Highlight Incorrect Under Adelaide Timezone

Component	Frontend / TimetablePage	Sprint	0507	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	TimetablePage.vue used toISOString().slice(0, 10) to generate date strings, which truncates by UTC time. This caused an incorrect date to be determined for the 'today' highlight when the local time is Australia/Adelaide (UTC+9:30/+10:30).			
Resolution	Replaced UTC-based date generation with a consistent Australia/Adelaide timezone-aware method for producing todayStr, dateStr, and the weekly title display.			

DEF-031 My Profile Page Incorrectly Exposes Editable Name and Email Fields

Component	Frontend / Profile	Sprint	0507	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	The Profile page presented student name and university email as editable form fields. These attributes are typically managed by institutional systems and should not be user-editable, creating a misleading interface.			
Resolution	Converted name and email to read-only display fields. Avatar upload functionality was retained. The name/email edit form and Program ID display were removed.			

DEF-032 MIT Roadmap Displays Non-IT Courses (Accounting, Agriculture, Aviation, etc.)

Component	Database / Seed Data	Sprint	0507	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	Critical	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	seed.sql hardcoded MIT program_courses to course_id 13–26. Due to subsequent seed changes, those IDs now map to ACCT, AGRI, EDUC, AERO, and BUSI courses. The genuine MIT courses occupy IDs 57–70 in the current seed.			
Resolution	Corrected the MIT program_courses mapping in seed.sql to reference the correct course IDs (57–70). Updated the local database program_id=3 course records to match.			

DEF-033 Homepage Featured Programs Images Not Displaying

Component	Frontend / HomePage,	Sprint	0507	FIXED
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	ProgramPreviewPage			
Severity	Medium	Priority	High	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	HomePage.vue depended on programs.banner_url for program card images, but all banner_url values in the database were NULL. Additionally, the homepage displayed the first four programs sorted alphabetically, which were not guaranteed to have local banner assets.			
Resolution	Replaced the dynamic program query on the homepage with four hardcoded demo programs that have local banner fallbacks. Added a banner fallback mechanism to ProgramPreviewPage as well.			

Additional Fixes

DEF-034 Auth Register / Login Validation Rules Not Taking Effect

Component	Backend / authController.js, routes/auth.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	routes/auth.js mounted express-validator middleware correctly, but authController.js register and login handlers never called validationResult(req) to read the validation outcome. Invalid requests bypassed validation and continued into bcrypt and database logic.			
Resolution	Added explicit validationResult(req) checks at the start of both register and login handlers. Requests that fail validation now return 400 VALIDATION_ERROR immediately, before reaching bcrypt or database operations.			

DEF-035 Discussion Post / Reply Validation Rules Not Taking Effect

Component	Backend / discussionController.js, routes/discussions.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	High	Priority	High	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	routes/discussions.js attached threadValidation and replyValidation middleware, but discussionController.js createThread and createReply handlers never called validationResult(req). Empty titles and empty body content were accepted and written to the database.			
Resolution	Added validationResult(req) checks at the start of createThread and createReply. Requests with empty title or empty content now return 400 VALIDATION_ERROR.			

DEF-036 Community Send Message Missing receiver_id Validation

Component	Backend / communityController.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	High	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	The sendMessage handler only validated content. receiver_id was not checked for presence or numeric validity. Invalid receiver_id values propagated to the database layer, triggering foreign key constraint errors and returning a 500 response to the client.			
Resolution	Added required presence and numeric validity checks for receiver_id in sendMessage. Invalid			

requests now return 400 VALIDATION_ERROR before reaching the database.

DEF-037 Community Connection Request — Type Mismatch Bypasses Self-Connect Check

Component	Backend / communityController.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	In sendConnectionRequest, requesterId sourced from the JWT token was a number, while receiver_id from req.body could be a string. The strict equality check (===) between the two types silently failed, allowing a user to send a connection request to themselves.			
Resolution	Applied Number() normalisation to receiver_id with a validity guard. The self-connect comparison now uses numeric equality, correctly blocking self-connection attempts.			

DEF-038 Community Connection Response — Invalid Action Silently Treated as Reject

Component	Backend / communityController.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	respondToConnection used a ternary: action === 'accept' ? 'accepted' : 'rejected'. Any value other than the exact string 'accept' — including typos, casing variants, or missing field — was silently treated as a rejection, inadvertently rejecting pending connection requests.			
Resolution	Restricted action to the explicit values 'accept' and 'reject'. Any other value now returns 400 VALIDATION_ERROR, preventing unintended automatic rejections.			

DEF-039 Auth Store Forces Logout on Any fetchUser Error

Component	Frontend / stores/auth.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	High	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	The fetchUser catch block in auth.js called logout() unconditionally. Transient network errors or 5xx backend responses cleared the local token, logging the user out despite the session remaining valid.			
Resolution	Modified the catch block to call logout() only when the response status code is 401 (Unauthorized). All other errors preserve the token, preventing involuntary logouts caused by temporary backend failures.			

DEF-040 Student Sidebar Dashboard Link Highlighted on All Sub-Pages

Component	Frontend / Level1Layout.vue	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	Level1Layout.vue used .router-link-active as the full highlight style for sidebar links. Because /student is a prefix of all /student/* routes, the Dashboard link remained in the active (highlighted) state on every student portal page.			
Resolution	Changed the full highlight style to .router-link-exact-active. .router-link-active is retained only for a			

lighter visual indicator, ensuring the Dashboard link is fully highlighted only when the route matches exactly.

DEF-041 Admin Dashboard Resources Card Navigates to Wrong Page

Component	Frontend / AdminDashboard.vue	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	The Resources stat card in AdminDashboard.vue was configured with route /admin/careers. Clicking it navigated to the career data management page rather than any resources-related page.			
Resolution	Temporarily changed the Resources card route to /admin/programs as a closer contextual match, pending a dedicated resources management page.			

DEF-042 My Profile Avatar Upload Button State Out of Sync with File Selection

Component	Frontend / Profile	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	The Upload button visibility was driven by fileInput?.files?.[0]. The browser's FileList object is not Vue-reactive, so cancelling a file selection or clearing the input did not trigger a re-render, leaving the Upload button in a stale visible state.			
Resolution	Introduced a selectedFile reactive ref to track the selected file. The Upload button now derives its visibility from selectedFile, ensuring correct synchronisation with user interaction.			

DEF-043 Pagination Returns Infinity for totalPages When limit Is Zero

Component	Backend / utils/response.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Medium	Priority	Medium	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	The paginated helper in response.js computed totalPages as Math.ceil(total / limit). When limit was 0 (or omitted), this produced Infinity, which serialised to null in JSON responses and broke client-side pagination logic.			
Resolution	Added a minimum-value guard: safeLimit = Math.max(1, parseInt(limit) 1). totalPages is now computed using safeLimit, preventing the division-by-zero outcome.			

DEF-044 Avatar Upload — Old File Cleanup Uses Empty catch, Swallowing Errors

Component	Backend / authController.js	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	In uploadAvatarHandler, the block responsible for deleting the previous avatar file used an empty catch block. Any filesystem or database error during cleanup was silently discarded, making post-incident debugging impossible.			
Resolution	Replaced the empty catch with a warning log that outputs cleanupErr.message. Errors are now surfaced in server logs without interrupting the upload response flow.			

DEF-045 Community Post Image Shows Broken Icon After Posting Without Page Refresh

Component	Frontend / CommunityHubPage.vue	Sprint	Additional	FIXED
Severity	Low	Priority	Low	Fixed: 07 May 2026
Description	After a post was submitted successfully, CommunityHubPage.vue reused the local blob URL preview in the newly rendered post. However, clearThreadImage() immediately called URL.revokeObjectURL() on that blob URL, destroying the object reference. The image in the new post then displayed as a broken icon until the page was refreshed, at which point the server-hosted /posts/... path loaded correctly.			
Resolution	Modified the post-submission cleanup flow to not revoke the blob URL when the new post still references it. The form input and state are reset without calling revokeObjectURL. The blob URL is naturally released after the page refreshes and the post image loads from the server path.			